Human development as recursive belief updating

Each consequence becomes the next activating event. Examining a belief produces a revised outlook that later beliefs keep building on.

1

2

3

4

$A_1 \rightarrow B_1 \rightarrow C_1$

$A_2 \rightarrow B_2 \rightarrow C_2$

D

E





Activating event

Something happens, such as a tense conversation.

Belief

How the event is interpreted in the moment.

Updated belief

Shaped by what the first consequence taught.

Examination

Question the belief: is it accurate, and is it useful?

Revised outlook

A more flexible way to read the next event.



B_1

B_2

Continuous belief revision

B_2 → B_3 → B_4 …











C_1



C_2



Consequence

The relationship is strained.

Consequence

The relationship is repaired.

Next event

The first consequence becomes the next thing that happens.

Schematic: the stages and outcomes are illustrative, not measured.

After the ABC model of cognitive-behavioural therapy (A activating event, B belief, C consequence), with D and E shown as examination and revised outlook.